

## Senior Software Engineer – Backend (Java, AWS, Event-Driven Systems)

**Location:** Orlando, FL

**Work Model:** Onsite 4 days per week (Friday remote)

**Office:** Feature Animation, Hollywood Studios

**Employment Type:** Contract

### About the Role

Disney Experiences Technology & Digital builds and operates technology that powers immersive, real-world guest experiences across parks, resorts, and connected products. This role supports a high-visibility initiative within the Connected Products platform, focused on ingesting, processing, and transforming real-time data from edge and IoT devices.

This is a **senior, hands-on engineering role** on a **small, highly trusted team**. The ideal candidate can immediately contribute, take ownership of system design decisions, and help evolve a critical platform into its next generation, including expansion into **computer vision-enabled capabilities**.

This is **not a machine learning or data science role**, but familiarity with computer vision systems and model integration is highly valuable.

### Key Responsibilities

- Design, build, and operate **real-time, event-driven backend systems** that ingest and process data from edge and IoT devices
- Develop backend services and streaming pipelines using **Java and Python** to transform device and model outputs into reliable events
- Architect and operate production systems on **AWS**, with emphasis on scalability, resiliency, observability, and cost efficiency
- Build clean, versioned **event schemas and APIs** for downstream consumers
- Integrate messaging and streaming technologies (on-prem and cloud)
- Collaborate closely with hardware, platform, and applied AI teams to operationalize model outputs
- Own architecture decisions, write design documentation, and act as a technical owner for key platform components
- Troubleshoot and optimize systems for performance, reliability, and throughput
- Contribute meaningfully in a small team environment with minimal handholding

### Required Qualifications

- **8+ years** of professional software engineering experience with demonstrated ownership of production systems
- Strong hands-on experience with **Java (core, modern versions)** and solid proficiency in **Python**
- Deep experience with **AWS**, including compute, messaging/streaming, and data services (AWS Lambda required)
- Strong understanding of **event-driven architecture** and distributed systems

- Experience with **streaming or messaging platforms** (e.g., Kafka, Kinesis, ActiveMQ, or similar)
- Experience integrating **IoT, edge, or device-based systems** into cloud platforms
- Ability to clearly explain architectural decisions and systems previously owned
- Strong problem-solving skills and ability to work independently in a fast-moving environment

### **Preferred Qualifications**

- Experience with **computer vision-adjacent systems**, such as object detection, counting, or boundary/zone detection
- Familiarity with processing image or sensor data from cameras or edge devices
- Experience operating **high-visibility, high-reliability systems**
- Experience with **stream processing frameworks** or high-throughput pipelines
- Experience building systems that handle **sensitive or privacy-relevant data** with strong security controls
- Familiarity with NoSQL data stores (e.g., DynamoDB)

### **Team & Culture**

- Small, senior, and highly collaborative team
- High ownership and accountability; contributors are expected to architect their way forward
- Emphasis on humility, clarity, and meaningful contribution
- High-visibility platform with executive-level exposure
- Significant opportunity for growth and influence as the platform evolves

### **Interview Process**

- Panel interview with technical and business stakeholders
- Take-home technical assessment focused on architecture, system design, and coding approach
- Evaluation based on technical depth, ownership, problem-solving ability, and overall fit

### **Education**

- Bachelor's degree in Computer Science, Engineering, or related field  
**OR**
- Equivalent professional experience (17+ years)